

Quiet Understanding

HUMAN MODE

Pocket card · Plan D for the sixty seconds after someone tells you something hard.

Don't diagnose. Ask — or say it sideways. Wait. Then help only if they want it.

1

Stop typing. Turn toward them.

2

Ask or say it sideways.
No diagnosis.

3

Wait longer than is comfortable.

4

Help only if they want it.

Anger · Try

“What landed hardest?”

“Walk me through it.”

Avoid: *“Calm down.”*

Sadness · Try

“What would actually help this week?”

“No need to apologize for being human in a hard season.”

Avoid: *“Stay strong.”*

Dejection · Try

“This stings. It isn't the whole story.”

“What's one piece you still own that we can build from?”

Avoid: *“This is a gift!”*

Question: “Do you have concerns about that change?”

Sideways: “I sense you're processing something.”

Not: “I can see that you're worried about the reorg.”

Jeffrey Sanchez-Burks · Human Mode (HarperCollins, 2027) · Free full guide via QR



Full guide + Starter Kit